

Compare the deal, not the pitch

A decision workbook for real rooftop-solar and battery proposals

The job

Bring 2–4 written proposals. Record facts; mark assumptions; turn gaps into questions.

Decision path

1 Normalize cash price 2 Separate financing 3 Compare production 4 Audit scope
5 Compare equipment 6 Compare warranties 7 Resolve gaps 8 Decide or pause

Quote intake: proposal A

Copy what the proposal says. Do not improve missing information.

Price

Cash price: _____ Financed principal: _____ Dealer fee disclosed? YES / NO / UNCLEAR

System size (kW DC): _____ Cash cost per watt: _____

Production assumptions

Annual production estimate: _____ kWh Utility escalation assumption: _____%

Shading/site model named? _____ Performance guarantee? _____

Evidence status

For each number mark: WRITTEN IN QUOTE / SALES CLAIM / CALCULATED / MISSING

Three-proposal normalization

One row, one comparable fact. “Included” is not a specification.

Core economics

A cash \$_____ \$/W_____ B cash \$_____ \$/W_____ C cash \$_____ \$/W_____

Loan principal A_____ B_____ C_____ Total scheduled payments A_____ B_____ C_____

System

DC size A_____ B_____ C_____ first-year production A_____ B_____ C_____

Gap question

Which proposal looks cheapest only because one scope item or finance cost is hidden? _____

Cash price and loan are separate decisions

A low APR does not prove a low total cost.

Normalize

Cash price: _____ Loan principal: _____ Difference: _____ Term: _____

Monthly payment before any re-amortization: _____ after: _____

Ask in writing

Is a dealer fee embedded? Can I use outside financing? Is there a prepayment penalty?

What happens if I sell the house before payoff?

Boundary

This workbook compares disclosed terms. It does not recommend a loan or replace legal advice.

Production is an estimate

Compare the inputs beneath the headline savings.

Trace the estimate

Usage baseline: _____ Roof orientation: _____ Shade assumption: _____

Panel degradation: _____ Utility-rate escalation: _____ Export-credit assumption: _____

Stress test

If export credit or escalation is lower, does the proposal still meet your objective? YES / NO / UNKNOWN

Question

Which assumption creates the largest difference between proposals? _____

What is actually included?

Turn “turnkey” into a written scope.

Included / excluded

Panel or roof work _____ Main-panel work _____ Permits _____ Interconnection _____
Monitoring _____ Critter guard _____ Trenching _____ Battery backup circuits _____

Handoff

Who owns each permit, inspection, utility submission and correction? _____

Stop sign

A material scope item is verbal only: PAUSE / GET WRITTEN CONFIRMATION

Map promises to responsible parties

A 25-year headline can hide several different warranties.

Separate

Panel product _____ performance _____ inverter _____ battery _____

Installer workmanship _____ roof penetration _____ labor/shipping exclusions _____

Failure path

Who receives the claim? _____ Who pays diagnosis? _____ What if installer closes? _____

Compare

Which warranty difference is real after exclusions and responsible-party risk? _____

Sign, question, or pause

A decision is allowed to remain unresolved.

Unresolved material items

1 _____ owner _____ due _____
2 _____ owner _____ due _____
3 _____ owner _____ due _____

Decision

SIGN A / SIGN B / SIGN C / REQUEST REVISED QUOTES / PAUSE

Reason in one sentence

We chose or paused because _____
